AI Speakers Club

Curriculum & Timeline

Prepared by Marwan Aljohani · 13 October 2026

Overview

The club runs **12 sessions** on Wednesdays, from 21 October 2026 to 17 March 2027, with breaks for exams, holidays, and online study periods.

Goal: build confidence and skill in public speaking, communication, and presentations for beginner members of the Applied AI program. Sessions are hands-on: members learn by speaking, not by listening to lectures. Each engagement runs up to two hours.

The curriculum moves through four phases:

1. **Foundations (Oct–Nov):** confidence, body language, voice.
2. **Communication (Dec):** openings, storytelling, slides, panel discussion.
3. **Presentations (Jan–Feb):** slide design, data, explaining tech.
4. **Graduation (Mar):** project practice and graduation.

Session Structure

Each engagement runs up to two hours, led by the Sergeant at Arms:

1. **Opening (~10 min):** the Sergeant at Arms welcomes everyone and explains the day's topic.
2. **Prepared speeches & activity (~45 min):** members who prepared speeches on the day's topic deliver them, followed by the session's hands-on activity.
3. **Table of Topics (~30 min):** volunteers answer impromptu questions of 1–2 minutes.
4. **Knowledge sharing (~10 min, optional):** one member shares something outside the day's agenda.
5. **Timer's report & close (~10 min):** the Timer reports, and the Sergeant at Arms wraps up.

Meeting Roles

Roles rotate weekly so every member tries each one.

Role	What they do
Sergeant at Arms	Runs the whole meeting, explains the topic, and introduces the prepared speakers
Prepared Speakers	Deliver speeches prepared in advance on the day's topic
Table of Topics Master	Prepares the impromptu questions and runs the Table of Topics segment
Table of Topics Volunteers	Answer impromptu questions on the spot
Timer	Tracks speaking time and signals time limits
Knowledge Sharer (optional)	Shares something useful from outside the day's agenda

Timeline

#	Date (Wed)	Session	What members do
1	21 Oct 2026	**Ice Breaker Night**	Each member gives a 1–2 minute “Who am I” talk · Recorded as their baseline
2	28 Oct 2026	**Table of Topics Starter**	Light “Would you rather” questions, 1 minute each · Members try the Timer role for the first time
3	4 Nov 2026	**Silent Speech**	Tell a short story with gestures only, then again with words · Audience guesses the story
4	11 Nov 2026	**Vocal Variety Challenge**	Say one sentence in five emotions · 1-minute talk with no filler words
5	9 Dec 2026	**Hook Battle**	Each member delivers three 30-second openings · Group votes for the strongest hook
6	16 Dec 2026	**Storytelling Circle**	3-minute personal stories · Audience shares one strength per speaker
7	23 Dec 2026	**Explain Your Slide**	Each member draws a random slide and explains it on the spot · Use PREP (Point, Reason, Example, Point)
8	30 Dec 2026	**AI Panel Discussion**	Members play moderator, panelists, and audience on an AI topic
9	6 Jan 2027	**Slide Makeover**	Pairs redesign a cluttered slide and present it in 2 minutes
10	27 Jan 2027	**Chart Talk**	Each member explains a chart in 90 seconds
11	3 Feb 2027	**Explain It Simply**	Explain an AI concept in 3 minutes · Audience plays non-technical listeners and asks basic questions
12	17 Mar 2027	**Graduation & Practice Your Project**	Members present their program projects with audience Q&A · Compare with Ice Breaker recording · Graduation recognition

Notes

- **Role sign-up:** share the role list a week ahead so members can prepare.
- **Tracking progress:** compare each member's Ice Breaker recording with their graduation speech.